Vantage Pulse FAQs

Getting Started / Onboarding

- **What is a Pulse Survey?**
  A Pulse Survey is a short, frequent survey that helps capture employee sentiment on key topics like workplace satisfaction, leadership, recognition, and wellbeing. Unlike traditional surveys, Pulse Surveys are typically 2–5 minutes long and conducted regularly to track trends over time.

- **What is Vantage Pulse?**
  Vantage Pulse is a continuous employee feedback platform designed to help organizations measure and improve employee engagement. It provides real-time insights into employee sentiment, enabling HR teams to take proactive actions based on feedback.

- **How is a Pulse Survey different from annual surveys?**
  Pulse Surveys are quick, ongoing check-ins, while annual surveys are more in-depth, typically conducted once a year. Pulse surveys allow you to act on feedback more frequently and address issues before they escalate, whereas annual surveys provide a broader, snapshot view of employee engagement.

- **How do I set up my first survey?**

  1. Go to your dashboard and click Create Survey.
  2. Choose a ready-made template, build your own, or create a template to reuse later.
  3. Add or edit questions.
  4. Pick the audience (teams, departments, or everyone).
  5. Schedule a start and end date.
  6. Preview, then click Launch Survey.
  7. Employees will then get the survey link by email.

- **What user roles exist?**

  Vantage Pulse supports three primary user roles with distinct permissions:

1. **Administrators (HR)**
   i. Create and launch surveys
   ii. View company-wide engagement insights and analytics
   iii. Manage user access and permissions
   iv. Configure integrations and data sources
   v. Generate comprehensive reports and export data
   vi. Access full platform functionality
   vii. Manage organizational configuration and settings
   viii. Typical Users: CHRO, HR Directors, Compensation & Benefits teams, Engagement specialists

2. Managers
   ix. View aggregated, anonymous results for their direct teams only
   x. Cannot see individual employee responses or identify respondents
   xi. Understand overall team sentiment and engagement trends
   xii. Share results with their teams
   xiii. Plan team-based action items based on engagement data
   xiv. Access team-specific insights and recommendations
   xv. View manager dashboards with team-level trends
   xvi. Typical Users: Department heads, team leads, supervisors

3. Employees
   xvii. Complete assigned surveys anonymously
   xviii. View personal engagement metrics and feedback (if enabled by admin)
   xix. Access organizational resources and insights (if enabled)
   xx. Provide honest feedback with full anonymity protections
   xxi. Cannot see other employees' responses or overall survey data
   xxii. Receive survey invitations via email
   xxiii. Access surveys on desktop, mobile, or kiosk

4. **Optional Advanced Roles:**
   xxiv. Segment Admins - Manage specific business units or regions (with appropriate permissions)
   xxv. HR Partners - Limited admin access for specific functions (viewing only, no configuration

Surveys & Feedback

- **How do Pulse Surveys work?**
  Pulse Surveys are short, regular check-ins that HR teams can customize and send out to employees to gather real-time feedback. Once the survey is created, employees receive an email with a link to complete it. Admins and managers can then analyze the aggregated data to understand employee sentiment.

- **What types of questions are included in Pulse Surveys?**
  Pulse surveys typically include multiple-choice questions, rating scales (**e.g., 1-5**), multi-choice questions and open-text questions. This mix allows you to capture both quantitative data and qualitative insights.

- **How frequently can I run pulse surveys?**
  You can schedule surveys to run **weekly, monthly, quarterly, or as a one-time survey**. Most organizations prefer monthly or quarterly pulses to keep feedback regular without overwhelming employees.

- **Can I create custom questions?**
  Yes! You can easily add your own questions to the survey, in addition to the pre-set ones. This way, you can ask exactly what you need to understand the unique needs and challenges within your team or organization.

- **Can surveys be targeted to specific teams or departments?**
  Absolutely. Surveys can be precisely segmented by:

  - **Department** - Target specific business units
  - **Location/Country** - Reach geographically dispersed teams
  - **Role/Job Level** - Target management, individual contributors, specialized roles
  - **Employee Lifecycle Stage** - New hires, experienced employees, high performers
  - **Custom Attributes** - Any custom field in your HRIS system (cost center, project, competency level, etc.)
  - **Organizational Hierarchy** - Business units, divisions, reporting lines
  - **Combination Targeting** - Multiple criteria simultaneously (e.g., "managers in US locations with 50+ direct reports")

  This targeting ensures feedback is relevant to specific groups and enables meaningful departmental comparisons and insights.

- **How often should surveys be sent?**
  Surveys can be sent monthly, quarterly, or based on specific needs. We recommend keeping the surveys short (under 5 minutes) to ensure employee participation and reduce fatigue.

- **Can I schedule surveys in advance?**
  Yes. Surveys can be scheduled in advance to launch on specific dates and times. The system can also automatically send reminders to non-respondents at configurable intervals, helping maximize participation rates.

- **How do I get a preview of the survey before launching it?**
  Vantage Pulse offers a preview feature so you can check how the survey will look to employees. This ensures there are no errors in the questions or logic before it's sent out.

- **Can I pause or end a survey before completion?**
  Yes. Surveys can be paused or ended at any time, giving you flexibility to respond to changing business circumstances. If you discover an error after launching, you can pause the current survey and create a new one with corrected information. This maintains data integrity while allowing necessary adjustments. Paused surveys can be resumed later if needed.

- **Can employees skip questions in the survey?**
  Yes, most questions in the survey are optional, particularly open-text questions. This ensures that employees can skip questions they are not comfortable answering, while still participating in the survey.

- **How do employees receive surveys?**
  Employees receive a personalized email containing a secure survey link with automatic authentication.
  The email includes relevant context about the survey purpose, estimated completion time, and a clear deadline for completion.
  The survey can be accessed and completed from any device, desktop computer, tablet, or mobile phone, at the employee's convenience during the designated survey window.
  Mobileoptimized interface ensures excellent experience on all devices.

- **Can I edit a survey after it's launched?**

No. Once a survey is active, it cannot be modified. This helps maintain consistency in the data and ensures all employees receive the same set of questions. If you notice an error after launching, you can pause or close the current survey and create a new one with the corrected details.

- **Can surveys be automated?**

  Yes. Vantage Pulse supports automated surveys triggered at important points in an employee's journey:

  - **Custom Time Intervals** - Trigger after 15, 30, 60, 90 days or any custom duration
  - **Work Anniversaries** - Automatically on employee work anniversaries
  - **Lifecycle Events** - Onboarding milestones, role transitions, departures
  - **Recurring Schedules** - Set up once and repeat automatically (weekly, monthly, quarterly)
  - **Trigger-Based** - Custom rules based on HRIS data changes (promotion, location change, etc.)

  Once automated rules are configured, surveys deploy without manual intervention, reducing administrative burden while ensuring consistent feedback collection and enabling longitudinal engagement tracking.

- **Can I run surveys for deskless or frontline employees?**

  Yes. Vantage Pulse supports Kiosk Mode surveys specifically designed for employees without regular computer or email access:

  - **QR Code Deployment** - Place QR codes in common areas (break rooms, notice boards, time clocks, entryways)
  - **Shared Kiosks** - Deploy on tablets or shared computers at worksites
  - **Easy Completion** - Simple interface optimized for quick surveys (2-3 minutes)
  - **Ideal for** - Retail stores, manufacturing facilities, distribution centers, restaurants, field operations, hospitality

  Kiosk surveys enable frontline and deskless employees to participate easily, ensuring their voices are heard in engagement efforts. No authentication or email required, employees simply scan QR code or access kiosk directly.

Dashboards & Analytics / Reports

What metrics or scores are shown on the dashboard?

The main metrics include:

- **Engagement Score:** Overall average score across all survey questions.
- **eNPS (Employee Net Promoter Score):** Measures employee loyalty and likelihood to recommend the company.
- **Participation Rate:** The percentage of employees who responded to the survey.

These metrics help you quickly assess employee morale and engagement health.

What does eNPS mean, and how is it calculated?

eNPS measures how likely employees are to recommend your organization as a great place to work, using a 5-point rating scale:

- **5 – Strongly Agree (Promoters)**
- **4 – Agree (Passives)**
- **1–3 – Neutral or Disagree (Detractors)**

The eNPS score is calculated as:
% of Promoters – % of Detractors.
A higher number means stronger advocacy and satisfaction.

What is the Heatmap in Vantage Pulse, and how does it work?

The Heatmap provides a visual comparison of engagement across organizational dimensions:

- **Rows** represent teams, departments, locations, or other organizational segments
- **Columns** represent engagement drivers (recognition, alignment, work environment, wellness, manager relationships, peer relationships, compensation, growth, autonomy, etc.)

Color Coding indicates performance levels:

- Green - Strong engagement (75+)
- Yellow - Moderate engagement (50-74)
- Orange - Below average (25-49)

- Red - Critical attention needed (below 25)

What is Employee Sentiment in Vantage Pulse?

Employee Sentiment analysis automatically categorizes open-text feedback to understand the emotional tone behind employee responses:

- **Very Positive** - Enthusiastic, highly satisfied, promoter-level comments
- **Positive** - Supportive, constructive, appreciative feedback
- **Neutral** - Factual or balanced observations without strong emotion
- **Negative** - Critical or concerning feedback, identifying problems
- **Very Negative** - Highly dissatisfied, alarming comments indicating serious issues

The system uses natural language processing and machine learning to automatically tag comments, eliminating manual categorization and human bias. This provides immediate visibility into the emotional tenor of feedback and helps identify emerging concerns quickly. Sentiment trends over time indicate shifting organizational mood and the effectiveness of engagement initiatives.

Can I export or share reports?

Yes. Reports can be exported in multiple formats:

- **PDF** - Professional formatted reports with charts, visualizations, and narrative insights for presentations.
- **Excel (.XLSX)** - Detailed data tables and charts for further analysis and custom calculations.
- **CSV** - Raw data export for import into other systems or advanced analysis.
- **PowerPoint** - Slide-ready insights for executive presentations.
- **Reports Include**: Visual charts, trend analysis, sentiment breakdowns, benchmark comparisons, narrative insights.
- **Scheduled Delivery** - Set up automated report email delivery to stakeholders on regular cadence.
- **Sharing Permissions** - Reports can be distributed to leaders, managers, and stakeholders with appropriate access permissions.

AI-Powered Intelligence & Recommendations

What is Pulse Intelligence?

Pulse Intelligence is Vantage Circle's AI-powered analytics engine that automatically analyzes survey data, identifies patterns, and generates actionable recommendations. Rather than requiring manual interpretation of data, Pulse Intelligence uses machine learning algorithms to:

- **Identify Trends** - Automatically detects engagement patterns and shifts over time
- **Spot Issues Early** - Flags concerning trends and at-risk segments before they escalate
- **Benchmark Analysis** - Compares your engagement scores against industry benchmarks to contextualize performance
- **Predictive Analytics** - Identifies employees at risk of attrition based on engagement signals
- **Prioritization** - Ranks improvement opportunities by potential impact and feasibility.

How do AI recommendations work?

Pulse Intelligence generates recommendations through a multistep process:

- **Data Analysis** - AI analyzes all survey responses, sentiment, participation patterns, and historical trends.
- **Pattern Recognition** - Machine learning identifies correlations between engagement drivers and business outcomes.
- **Benchmarking** - Compares your metrics against industry peers to contextualize performance.
- **Impact Assessment** - Prioritizes recommendations by estimated impact on overall engagement and retention.
- **Actionability Rating** - Ranks recommendations by feasibility and implementation ease.
- **Presentation** - Displays top recommendations with specific action steps and expected outcomes.

For example: "Improving Recognition category by 14 points would increase overall Engagement Score by 3 points. Recommended action: Implement peer recognition program."

What types of insights does the system provide?

Pulse Intelligence provides several categories of insights:

Engagement Drivers Analysis:

- Which factors most strongly correlate with high overall engagement
- Which departments need attention in specific engagement categories
- Comparative performance of engagement drivers (what's strong vs. weak)

Employee Segmentation:

- High performers vs. at-risk employees
- New hire onboarding effectiveness
- Retention risk indicators
- Department-specific engagement profiles

Trend Analysis:

- Month-over-month engagement movement
- Quarterly trend tracking
- Impact of organizational initiatives on engagement
- Predictive engagement trajectory

Actionable Recommendations:

- Specific initiatives with estimated impact
- Priority ranking for improvement efforts
- Best practices based on peer organizations
- Risk mitigation suggestions

Attrition Risk Prediction:

- Early identification of flight-risk employees (based on engagement scores)
- Departmental retention risk assessment
- Lifecycle stage vulnerability analysis

- ### How accurate are the recommendations?

  Vantage Circle's recommendation engine has been validated against millions of survey responses across 700+ client organizations. The accuracy of recommendations depends on:

  - **Data Quality** - More responses = more accurate analysis (minimum 30 responses recommended for reliable insights)

- **Historical Data** - Systems with 2+ survey cycles show significantly higher prediction accuracy
- **Organization Size** - Larger organizations with diverse data patterns show stronger correlation patterns

Validation Approach:

- Recommendations are back tested against historical outcomes
- Success rates are tracked and continuously improved
- Organizations can provide feedback on recommendation effectiveness
- System learns from successful vs. unsuccessful implementations

Most organizations see accuracy rates of 75-85% when implementing top-ranked recommendations, with higher accuracy for larger organizations with longer histories.

- ### Can I customize AI recommendations?

  Yes. You can customize recommendation generation:

  - **Focus Areas** - Specify which engagement drivers are priorities for your organization
  - **Impact vs. Effort** - Choose to prioritize high-impact initiatives or quick wins
  - **Timeline** - Focus on short-term (immediate) or long-term strategic improvements
  - **Segment-Specific** - Generate recommendations specific to certain departments or employee groups
  - **Exclude Options** - Mark recommendations you've already implemented to avoid repetition

  This customization ensures recommendations align with your organizational strategy and capacity.

Benchmarking & Comparative Analysis

- **What is industry benchmarking in Vantage Pulse?**
  Industry benchmarking in Vantage Pulse enables organizations to compare their engagement metrics against industry peers and standards. This provides important context, your engagement score is only meaningful when compared to similar organizations facing similar workforce challenges.

  Benchmark Comparison Data:

  - **Overall Engagement Score** - Compare against industry average, top quartile, and peer organizations
  - **eNPS Benchmark** - See how your employee advocacy compares to peers
  - **Category Benchmarks** - Compare specific engagement drivers (manager relationships, compensation, growth, etc.)
  - **Variance Analysis** - Identify areas where you're significantly above or below benchmark

- **How does your benchmark data compare to industry standards?**Vantage Pulse benchmark data is built from aggregated, anonymized responses across 700+ client organizations representing 2M+ employees globally. Benchmarks are segmented by:

  - **Industry Sector** - Financial services, technology, manufacturing, healthcare, retail, etc.
  - **Company Size** - Small (50-500), Mid-market (500-5K), Enterprise (5K+)
  - **Geography** - Regional and country-specific benchmarks accounting for cultural differences
  - **Employee Type** - Frontline, hybrid, remote-first organizations

  Benchmark Positioning: Your scores are compared against relevant peer groups, with percentage-point variance clearly displayed:

  - **Above Benchmark** - "Your Manager Relationship score is 8 points above industry average"
  - **Below Benchmark** - "Your Wellness score is 12 points below peer organizations"
  - **Percentile Ranking** - "You rank in the 72nd percentile for overall engagement vs. industry peers"

Manager Features & Capabilities

What can managers see in Vantage Pulse?

Managers have access to team-specific dashboards showing:

Team-Level Metrics:

- Overall team engagement score and trend
- Team eNPS with promoter/passive/detractor breakdown
- Team participation rate
- Team-level category scores (manager relationships, peer relationships, etc.)
- Sentiment distribution for team feedback

Team Analytics:

- Anonymized comment trends and themes for their team
- Engagement drivers - what's working well vs. needs improvement for the team
- Individual participation (who responded, response rate) but NOT responses themselves
- Comparison of team metrics to company average and peer teams

Important Limitation: Managers CANNOT:

- See individual employee responses or identify who said what
- View specific employee names linked to feedback
- Access company-wide data outside their span of control
- See responses from employees they don't manage

This design maintains anonymity while enabling managers to understand their team's collective sentiment and take action.

What's the manager onboarding process?

Manager Onboarding Timeline: 2-3 weeks

Phase 1: Setup (Week 1)

- Account manager identifies all managers who should have access
- Managers are provisioned in the system
- Role permissions are configured

Phase 2: Training (Week 1-2)

- Manager training session on dashboard navigation
- How to interpret engagement metrics and scores
- How to use insights to lead their teams
- Overview of best practices and resources available
- Q&A and troubleshooting

Phase 3: First Survey (Week 2-3)

- Managers access team dashboard for first time
- Guided walkthrough of their team's results
- Account manager available for questions and interpretation
- Initial action planning support

Ongoing Support:

- Access to manager resources and libraries
- Regular refresher trainings as new features roll out
- Account manager check-ins on progress and challenges

Employee Lifecycle Management

What is the Employee Lifecycle feature in Vantage Pulse?

The Employee Lifecycle feature enables organizations to track and measure employee engagement across distinct career stages:

Lifecycle Stages:

1. **Onboarding (0-3 months)** - New employee integration and initial organizational experience assessment
2. **Early Development (3-12 months)** - Early career growth, skill development, and role mastery phase
3. **Career Progression (1-5+ years)** - Mid-career development, advancement opportunities, and continued engagement
4. **Long-Term Engagement (5+ years)** - Experienced employees, organizational veterans, and tenured staff
5. **Separation/Offboarding** - Departure experience, exit reasons, and organizational improvement feedback

Purpose: The feature helps organizations understand engagement patterns throughout the employee journey, identify flight risks at critical stages, optimize

experiences at career transitions, and understand which lifecycle phases have the highest attrition risk.

- ## How do automated lifecycle surveys work?

  Lifecycle surveys can be configured to trigger automatically at predefined points in an employee's journey:

  Timing Options:

  - **After specific days** - 15, 30, 60, 90-day surveys for new hires to assess onboarding effectiveness
  - **On work anniversaries** - Annual engagement check-ins on hire date anniversaries
  - **At role transitions** - Automatically triggered by job changes, promotions, or department transfers
  - **Custom intervals** - Configure any relevant milestone based on your organizational needs
  - **Termination-triggered** - Automatic exit survey when employee separates

  Process:

  1. Configure lifecycle survey templates for each stage
  2. Set up automatic triggers based on hire dates, lifecycle stage, or events
  3. System monitors employee records and automatically deploys surveys at trigger points
  4. Employees receive targeted survey invitations relevant to their career stage
  5. Responses are analyzed separately by lifecycle stage
  6. Trends and patterns inform retention strategies and stage-specific improvements

  Benefit: Automated lifecycle surveys reduce administrative burden while ensuring consistent engagement measurement throughout the employee journey and capturing critical feedback at key moments.

- ## Can I customize lifecycle surveys?

  Yes. Lifecycle surveys are fully customizable:

  - **Question Selection** - Choose specific questions relevant to each career stage
  - **Custom Questions** - Add organization-specific or role-specific questions
  - **Frequency** - Set survey frequency and timing tailored per stage

- **Targeting** - Target surveys to specific employee populations, departments, or roles
- **Templates** - Choose from pre-built lifecycle templates or create completely custom ones
- **Branching Logic** - Conditional questions based on employee responses or attributes
- **Localization** - Translate surveys for multi-language organizations
- **Recommendations by Stage:**
- **Onboarding:** Focus on clarity, manager relationship, culture fit, training effectiveness
- **Early Development:** Assess growth opportunities, role mastery, team relationships, career clarity
- **Career Progression:** Measure advancement opportunities, recognition, engagement, retention factors
- **Long-Term:** Track loyalty, burnout risk, mentorship, organizational evolution alignment
- **Separation:** Capture exit reasons, experience quality, improvement suggestions

Customization & Configuration

How customizable are survey templates?

Survey templates in Vantage Pulse offer extensive customization:

Pre-Built Templates:

- 25+ ready-to-use survey templates for common use cases
- Industry-specific templates (tech, healthcare, retail, manufacturing, etc.)
- Lifecycle-specific templates (onboarding, exit, engagement pulse, etc.)

Customization Capabilities:

- **Questions** - Add, remove, reorder, or modify pre-built questions
- **Scoring** - Customize rating scales (1-5, 1-10, agree/disagree, etc.)
- **Question Types** - Mix rating scales, multiple choice, open text, matrix, ranking
- **Branching Logic** - Conditional questions (e.g., "If you said 'No', why?")
- **Languages** - Translate surveys into 16+ languages
- **Branding** - Add company logos, colors, and custom instructions
- **Time Estimates** - Display estimated completion time to respondents

Reusable Question Libraries:

- Save frequently-used questions for consistency
- Maintain organizational question standards
- Version control for questions that evolve over time
- Share question libraries across your organization

Save as Templates:

- Create custom templates from your customized surveys
- Reuse for similar survey cycles (e.g., monthly pulse)
- Template versioning and management

- ### Can we white-label the platform?

Vantage Pulse supports limited white-labeling options:

Available Customization:

- **Company Logo** - Display your logo in survey headers and email invitations
- **Color Scheme** - Customize primary and accent colors to match brand
- **Branding Messages** - Add custom thank-you messages and instructions
- **Email Signatures** - Customize survey email invitations and reminders
- **Custom Domain** - Options for branded survey URLs (on higher tiers)

Limitations:

- Full white-labeling (complete platform reskinning) not available in standard offering
- Can discuss enterprise white-label options for large deployments

Recommendation: Most organizations appreciate the Vantage Pulse branding as it enhances credibility with employees ("this is a professional engagement platform").

Sentiment Analysis & Comment Management

- ## How does sentiment analysis work?

  Vantage Pulse uses advanced Natural Language Processing (NLP) and machine learning to automatically analyze open-text employee feedback:

  Analysis Process:

  1. **Comment Capture** - System captures all open-text responses from surveys
  2. **Processing** - NLP algorithms analyze text for emotion, context, and intent
  3. **Categorization** - Comments automatically tagged with sentiment classification:
     a. Very Positive
     b. Positive
     c. Neutral
     d. Negative
     e. Very Negative
  4. **Theme Extraction** - System identifies recurring themes and topics (recognition, manager, compensation, growth, etc.)
  5. **Aggregation** - Comments grouped by theme and sentiment for pattern analysis

  Accuracy:

  - System trained on millions of employee comments
  - Accuracy rates 85-90% for sentiment classification
  - Manual review capability to adjust misclassified comments
  - Continuous improvement through feedback loops

  Benefits:

  - Eliminates manual comment reading and categorization
  - Identifies themes and patterns humans might miss
  - Faster insight generation
  - Objective, consistent analysis

- ## Can I filter comments by sentiment?

  Yes. Extensive comment filtering and analysis options:

  Sentiment Filtering:

- View comments by sentiment level (very positive, positive, neutral, negative, very negative)
- Focus on critical issues (very negative comments) for immediate attention
- Identify positive themes and successes

Theme Filtering:

- Comments organized by topic (manager, compensation, growth, recognition, culture, etc.)
- Drill down to specific themes (e.g., "all comments about career development")
- Combine sentiment + theme (e.g., "negative comments about compensation")

Segmentation Filtering:

- Filter comments by department, location, role, tenure
- Understand sentiment variations across organizational segments
- Identify which groups have specific concerns

Text Search:

- Search for specific keywords (e.g., "remote work," "team," "promotion")
- Find comments mentioning specific topics
- Quick identification of emerging concerns

Export & Analysis:

- Export filtered comments to Excel/CSV
- Further analysis in external tools if needed
- Share specific feedback with relevant stakeholders

- ### Can I export comments by category?

Yes. Comprehensive comment export options:

Export Capabilities:

- **By Sentiment** - Export all negative comments, all positive comments, etc.
- **By Theme/Category** - Export comments about specific topics (compensation, manager, growth)
- **By Segment** - Export comments from specific department, location, role

- **Combined Filters** - Very negative compensation comments from engineering department
- **Date Range** - Export comments from specific time period
- **Verbatim Comments Only** - Exclude system-generated metadata

Export Formats:

- **Excel (.XLSX)** - Spreadsheet with comments, sentiment, theme, source
- **CSV** - Raw text format for analysis in other tools
- **PDF Report** - Formatted report with examples and analysis
- **Word Document** - Comments with formatting for distribution

Analysis Options:

- Comments organized in sortable/filterable format
- Metadata included (responder segment, survey date, theme, sentiment)
- Optional anonymization for sensitive sharing

Use Cases:

- Share negative feedback with relevant managers for action planning
- Present positive comments in all-hands meetings for morale boosting
- Provide specific examples to justify investment in improvement initiatives
- Document evidence for compensation or benefit discussions

○ What languages does sentiment analysis support?

Primary Languages (Native Support with High Accuracy):

- English
- Spanish
- French
- German
- Portuguese
- Italian
- Dutch
- Swedish
- Norwegian
- Danish
- Polish
- Russian

Extended Languages (Via Translation):

- 16+ total languages supported
- Surveys available in all supported languages
- Comments in other languages can be auto-translated to English before sentiment analysis
- Translation quality varies by language pair

Multilingual Organizations:

- Comments analyzed in original language when possible
- Auto-translation to English for centralized analysis if needed
- Separate analysis reports by language available
- Cultural considerations in sentiment interpretation

Note: Sentiment analysis works best with English comments. For non-English comments, we recommend combining automated analysis with human review to ensure cultural context and nuance are properly understood.

Security, Privacy & Compliance

Are Pulse Survey responses anonymous?

Yes. All survey responses in Vantage Pulse are completely anonymous:

- **Response Anonymity** - Survey responses are not linked to individual employee names in the system
- **Aggregated Reporting** - Results are displayed only in aggregated group format, never as individual responses
- **No Identification** - Administrators cannot identify who gave specific answers
- **Honest Feedback** - Anonymity ensures employees can provide candid, unbiased feedback without fear of retaliation or consequences
- **Technical Safeguards** - Response data is stored separately from employee identifiers, making linkage technically impossible

Anonymity Protection for Small Teams: To maintain confidentiality in small groups, team-level results are only displayed when at least 5 employees respond. If a team has fewer than 5 respondents, their feedback is automatically combined with organization-wide data to prevent individual

identification.

- ### Who can see employee answers?

  Visibility Hierarchy:

  - **HR Administrators** - View company-wide aggregated results and insights only; cannot see individual responses
  - **Managers** - See aggregated results only for their direct teams; cannot view individual responses or identify respondents
  - **Other Employees** - Cannot access survey results (unless specific sharing permissions are granted by administrators for team results)
  - **No Individual Viewing** - No user role can see individual employee responses or identify who gave specific answers

  Aggregated Data Only: All reported results are presented in summary format (percentages, averages, sentiment themes) rather than individual responses.

- ### How is employee data protected?

  Vantage Pulse implements enterprise-grade security practices:

  Encryption:
  - All data is encrypted in transit (SSL/TLS 1.2+) and at rest using AES-256 encryption
  - Sensitive employee information is protected with advanced encryption protocols
  - Encryption keys are securely managed and regularly rotated

  Access Control:
  - Role-based access controls (RBAC) restrict data viewing based on user permissions
  - Multi-factor authentication (MFA) available for enhanced security
  - Administrative access is logged and monitored for audit purposes
  - Only authorized personnel can access sensitive employee data
  - Session management and automatic logout after inactivity

  Data Centers:
  - Hosted on secure, enterprise-grade cloud infrastructure (Digital Ocean Enterprise)
  - Multiple geographic locations available for data residency compliance

- Data centers maintain SOC 2 Type II compliance
- Regular security audits and penetration testing
- 24/7/365 monitoring and incident response

Backup & Disaster Recovery:

- Automated backups with multiple geographic redundancy
- Disaster recovery protocols ensure business continuity
- Regular backup restoration testing validates recovery capability
- Recovery Time Objective (RTO): <4 hours; Recovery Point Objective (RPO): <1 hour

Network Security:

- DDoS protection and rate limiting
- Web application firewall (WAF) for attack prevention
- Regular vulnerability scans and remediation
- Intrusion detection and prevention systems

Can responses ever be traced back to an individual?

No. Safeguards are in place to ensure that responses cannot be linked back to a single person. If a group is too small, results are hidden to protect anonymity.

How is anonymity protected for small teams?

To maintain confidentiality and prevent identification in small teams:

- **Minimum Response Threshold** - Team-level results are displayed **only if at least 5 employees respond** to a survey
- **Automatic Aggregation** - If a team has fewer than 5 respondents, their feedback is automatically combined with organization-wide aggregate data
- **No Individual Identification** - This prevents calculation of individual responses through elimination
- **Applies To** - Departments, locations, business units, reporting lines, or any segmentation with fewer than 5 respondents
- **Example:** If a specific department has only 3 employees, their survey responses would not be shown separately. Instead, they'd be included only in the broader organization-wide results.

Flexibility: Organizations can request adjustment to the minimum threshold (e.g., 10 respondents instead of 5) for additional privacy protection, though lower thresholds provide better data visibility.

- ## Where is data hosted?

  Vantage Pulse's data is hosted on enterprise-grade cloud infrastructure with the following specifications:

  Cloud Provider: Digital Ocean Enterprise Cloud Services

  Geographic Availability: Infrastructure is established across multiple global regions, enabling:

  - **US Region** - Data centers in Eastern US (primary), Western US (backup)
  - **EU Region** - EU data centers in compliance with GDPR residency requirements
  - **APAC Region** - Asian-Pacific data centers for regional compliance and performance
  - **Custom Regions** - Additional regions available for specific compliance needs

  Data Residency Compliance:

  - Organizations can specify their required data residency region during onboarding
  - Data stays within the specified region for regulatory compliance (GDPR, DPDP, etc.)
  - No cross-border data transfer occurs without explicit authorization
  - Compliance documentation available for audit purposes

  Infrastructure Quality:

  - Enterprise-grade security and reliability (99.99% uptime SLA)
  - Regular backups with geographic redundancy
  - Multiple failover and disaster recovery protocols
  - Monitored 24/7/365 with automated incident response
  - DDoS protection and advanced security measures

  Performance:

  - Content Delivery Network (CDN) for fast global access
  - Low-latency access from any geographic location
  - Optimized database performance for real-time analytics
  - Automatic scaling to handle usage spikes

Specific Region Assignment: To confirm the exact data center location for your organization or to request specific regional hosting, please contact your account manager during onboarding.

- ## What security standards and certifications do you follow?

Information Security Management:

- **ISO 27001:2013:2019 Certified** - Comprehensive information security management system certification demonstrating compliance with international information security standards.
- Includes controls for access management, encryption, incident response, and business continuity.

Data Privacy & Compliance:

- **GDPR Compliant** - Full compliance with General Data Protection Regulation for EU and UK operations
    - Data subject rights (access, deletion, portability) supported
    - Data Processing Agreements (DPA) available
    - Privacy by Design principles implemented
- **DPDP Compliant** - Adherence to India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act
    - Appropriate data handling and consent management
    - Data localization requirements for India operations
- **CCPA Ready** - Compliance with California Consumer Privacy Act for US west coast operations
- **LGPD Compliant** - Brazil's Lei Geral de Proteção de Dados compliance for Latin America

Cloud Infrastructure:

- **Digital Ocean Enterprise Hosting** - Secured, enterprise-grade cloud infrastructure provider
- **SOC 2 Type II Certified** - Annual third-party audits of security, availability, and confidentiality controls

Data Security:

- **AES-256 Encryption** - Advanced encryption for data at rest
- **TLS 1.2+** - SSL/TLS encryption for data in transit

- **End-to-End Encryption** - Support available for highly sensitive implementations

Regular Audits & Assessments:

- Annual independent security audits and assessments
- Continuous vulnerability scanning and penetration testing
- Third-party security validation reports available upon request
- Regular updates to security protocols to address emerging threats
- Incident response plan with SLA commitments

Business Continuity:

- Business Continuity Plan (BCP) with documented procedures
- Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP) with <4 hour RTO
- Regular testing and validation of recovery procedures
- Backup and restore capabilities

Compliance Documentation: We can provide detailed compliance documentation including:

- ISO 27001 certification documents
- SOC 2 Type II audit reports
- Data Processing Agreements (DPA) for GDPR
- Security assessment reports
- Specific certifications for industry requirements (HIPAA BAA for healthcare, etc.)

Contact your account manager to request compliance documentation for your specific requirements.

Data Management & Integration

- **How does Vantage Pulse handle duplicate employee records?**Vantage Pulse manages employee data through a structured onboarding process that minimizes duplication:

Data Import Methods:

- **CSV File Upload** - Upload employee data via CSV file with automatic deduplication checks

- **SFTP Integration** - Secure file transfer protocol for automated data uploads
- **HRIS Integration** - Direct integration with your existing HRIS system

Duplicate Prevention & Management:

- During onboarding, our implementation team works with you to establish proper data mapping using unique identifiers (employee ID, email, etc.)
- The system identifies potential duplicates based on configurable matching rules (exact name + email match, employee ID, etc.)
- Manual review and reconciliation during initial data load ensures accuracy
- For ongoing data syncs, HRIS integration maintains data integrity through single source of truth

How often is data updated?

Real-Time Updates:

- Survey data and analytics are updated in real-time
- Each time an employee submits or updates a survey response, data is processed and reflected immediately
- Dashboard metrics refresh as responses are collected
- No lag between survey submission and data availability

Anonymity Threshold:

- To maintain employee anonymity, aggregated results are only displayed once a minimum threshold of **5 responses** has been received
- This prevents identification of individuals in small teams

Employee Data Sync Frequency:

- **HRIS Integration** - Syncs automatically based on configured schedule:
  - Standard: Daily overnight sync
  - Real-time: Continuous sync (for high-frequency changes)
  - Custom: Configured to your preferred frequency
- **CSV Upload** - Manual uploads are processed immediately upon completion
- **SFTP** - Scheduled uploads processed at configured times (typically daily)

Reporting & Analytics Refresh:

- All reports and dashboards refresh in real-time as data is collected
- Trend analysis and historical comparisons available as soon as second survey completes
- Benchmark comparisons updated quarterly when industry data refreshes

- ## Can I connect multiple data sources?

Yes, Vantage Pulse supports multiple data source scenarios:

Multi-HRIS Integration:

- Organizations with multiple HRIS systems can integrate all of them simultaneously
- Common use case: One HRIS for US operations, another for international offices
- Vantage Pulse consolidates employee data from all sources into unified view
- Data mapping ensures consistency across HRIS systems
- Deduplication rules applied across all sources to prevent employee duplication

Hybrid Data Approach:

- Combine HRIS integration with manual CSV uploads for data not in HR system
- Useful for contractors, consultants, or other worker populations
- Implementation team helps manage data governance across sources

External System Integration:

- Survey data can be exported to external systems (Workday, SAP, etc.)
- API access available for custom integrations
- Webhooks support real-time data flow to other business applications

Data Consolidation Benefits:

- Single unified employee database across organizational silos
- Comprehensive employee segmentation for survey targeting
- Accurate participation tracking across all worker populations
- Holistic engagement view of entire workforce

Configuration Examples:

- "We use Workday for corporate employees and BambooHR for contract workers"
- "We operate in 5 countries with 3 different HRIS systems"
- "We want to sync survey results back into our Workday systems"

Next Steps for Your Organization: Discuss your specific data source architecture with your account manager during implementation planning.

Can I import employee data manually if I don't have an HRIS integration?

Yes. If you don't currently have HRIS integration, you can import employee data manually:

CSV Upload Method:

- Prepare CSV file with employee details (name, employee ID, department, location, manager, email, etc.)
- Upload via admin panel with field mapping configuration
- System organizes employees by department, manager, location, and other attributes
- Data is processed and ready for survey distribution within minutes
- Validation report identifies any data quality issues before surveys launch

Upload Frequency:

- One-time upload for initial setup
- Periodic uploads (weekly, monthly, quarterly) to keep employee data current
- No limit on upload frequency

Future HRIS Integration:

- Once your HR system is ready, transition to automated HRIS synchronization
- This eliminates manual updates and ensures ongoing data accuracy
- Implementation team assists with migration from CSV to integrated approach

Support: Our implementation team provides CSV templates with proper field naming and formatting. We also review your data for quality and offer

recommendations on data governance best practices.

Commercial Terms & Governance

How is Vantage Pulse priced?

Vantage Pulse uses a **per-employee per-month (PEPM) pricing model**:

Pricing Structure:

- **Base Price:** Cost per active employee per month
- **Scaling:** Discounts typically apply at higher employee counts
- **Volume Tiers:** Organizations with 500+ employees, 1000+, 5000+, 10000+ employees receive increasingly favorable pricing
- **Flexibility:** Pay only for active employees in your organization

What's Included:

- Unlimited surveys (create as many as needed)
- Unlimited survey responses and data storage
- All survey templates and customization
- All analytics and reporting features
- AI-powered Pulse Intelligence and recommendations
- Manager dashboards and employee access
- All standard integrations (HRIS, SSO, email, etc.)
- Kiosk mode for frontline employees
- Real-time analytics and dashboards
- All security and compliance features
- Standard support and account management
- Platform updates and new features

Optional Add-Ons:

- **Premium Support** - Dedicated account manager with extended hours
- **Professional Services** - Implementation, training, or change management
- **Custom Integrations** - Development of non-standard integrations
- **White-Label Solutions** - Enterprise white-labeling options
- **Advanced Analytics** - Custom reporting or predictive modeling

Annual vs. Monthly Billing:

- Annual agreements typically offer 10-15% discount vs. month-to-month
- Multi-year agreements provide additional savings
- Flexible billing arrangements available for larger deals

Contract Terms:

- Typically 12-month minimum commitment
- Month-to-month available at premium pricing
- No long-term lock-in required (annual minimum standard)
- Volume discounts honored throughout contract

ROI Context:

- Average ROI achieved within 6-12 months through:
  - Improved retention (reduced hiring costs)
  - Improved productivity (engaged employees, more productive)
  - Faster identification and resolution of issues (reduced escalation)
  - Data-driven decision-making (better resource allocation)

For Custom Pricing: Contact your account manager or sales team for specific pricing based on your organization size, requirements, and contract duration.

- **What happens if we exceed usage limits?**

  Unlike some competitors, **Vantage Pulse does not have strict usage limits**. Here's how it works:

  Flexible Usage:

  - **Unlimited Surveys** - Create and run as many surveys as needed
  - **Unlimited Responses** - Collect unlimited survey responses
  - **Unlimited Data Storage** - Historical data retained indefinitely
  - **Unlimited Users** - Add as many administrators, managers, and employees as needed
  - **Unlimited Reports** - Generate and export as many reports as needed

  No Overage Fees:

  - No surprise charges for exceeding limits
  - No throttling or performance degradation
  - No restrictions on survey frequency
  - No restrictions on survey length

Scalability:

- Platform automatically scales to handle your organization's survey activity
- No performance impact, regardless of survey volume or response volume
- Same pricing for light or heavy survey usage

Best Practices (Not Requirements):

- Survey frequency recommendations: monthly or quarterly for optimal engagement
- Survey length recommendations: under 5 minutes to maximize participation
- Participation optimization: focus on quality over quantity

Example:

- Organization running 10 surveys per month = Same price as organization running 1 survey per month
- Organization with 80% participation = Same price as organization with 30% participation

Billing Reality:

- You only pay per active employee regardless of survey activity
- No limits on usage that would trigger additional charges
- Predictable, transparent pricing

- ## Do you have an SLA (Service Level Agreement)?

Uptime Guarantee:

- **99.9% Availability SLA** - Platform available 99.9% of time (approximately 43 minutes downtime per month)
- **Measurement** - Uptime measured from external monitoring points
- **Exclusions** - Planned maintenance windows (typically 2–4 hours quarterly, scheduled with advance notice)
- **Global Coverage** - Uptime calculated across all geographic regions

Performance SLA:

- **Page Load Time** - Dashboard loads within 3 seconds for 95% of requests

- **Report Generation** - Standard reports generated within 60 seconds
- **Survey Deployment** - Surveys deployed and emails sent within 15 minutes
- **Data Processing** - Survey responses processed and reflected in real-time analytics within 5 minutes

Support SLA:

- **Critical Issues** - Response within 1 hour
- **High Priority** - Response within 4 business hours
- **Medium Priority** - Response within 24 business hours
- **Low Priority** - Response within 48 business hours

Credits for SLA Breaches:

- Outages tracked and credited automatically
- Service credits applied to next billing period
- Detailed uptime reports available to customers
- Escalation path for significant SLA breaches

Maintenance Windows:

- **Scheduled Maintenance** - Announced 2 weeks in advance
- **Typical Duration** - 2–4 hours quarterly
- **Timing** - Scheduled during low-usage hours (typically 2-6 AM US time)
- **Communication** - Status page updated; emails sent to administrators

Disaster Recovery SLA:

- **Recovery Time Objective (RTO)** - Service restored within 4 hours of incident
- **Recovery Point Objective (RPO)** - No more than 1 hour of data loss
- **Backup Testing** - Recovery procedures tested monthly
- **Geographic Redundancy** - Backup infrastructure in separate geographic region

Compliance:

- SLA terms included in standard contracts
- Enterprise SLA terms negotiable for large customers
- Documentation available upon request
- Regular SLA performance reporting

Troubleshooting & Support

I can't log in to my Vantage Pulse account. What should I do?

1. Verify Credentials

- Confirm you're using correct username/email address
- Check for CAPS LOCK or typos in password
- Ensure you're not using an old password if recently changed
- Verify email matches the address used during registration

2. Password Recovery

- Click **"Forgot Password"** on login screen
- Enter your email address
- Check your inbox for password reset email
- Click reset link (may take 5–10 minutes to arrive)
- Create new password and try logging in
- Check spam/junk email folder if email doesn't arrive

3. Account Activation

- If new to the platform, confirm you've completed initial setup
- Check for welcome/activation email from Vantage Circle
- Click activation link in email to activate account
- May need to activate account before first login attempt
- Check spam folder if welcome email missing

4. Browser & Connectivity Issues

- Try a different browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge)
- Clear browser cache and cookies:
  - Chrome: Ctrl+Shift+Delete
  - Firefox: Ctrl+Shift+Delete
  - Safari: Preferences > Privacy > Manage Website Data
- Verify you have stable internet connection
- Try incognito/private browsing mode
- Disable browser extensions that might interfere
- Try different device to isolate issue

5. SSO Issues (if using Single Sign-On)

- Verify SSO credentials, work with your company's identity provider
- Confirm your SSO account is active with your company
- Check if SSO access is restricted to specific IP addresses
- Contact your IT department if SSO access is blocked
- Request your IT team to check SSO integration status

6. Account Lock

- Multiple failed login attempts may lock your account temporarily
- Wait 15–30 minutes before trying again
- Try password reset to unlock account
- Check if your account has been deactivated by admin

7. Contact Support

- If issues persist after trying above steps, contact support immediately
- Email: partner@vantagecircle.com
- Call your dedicated account manager
- Provide: email address, error message, steps already attempted, browser/device info
- **Response time:** Critical issues resolved within 1 hour

Pro Tip: Bookmark the login page (https://pulse.vantagecircle.com) for quick access. Verify your login credentials with your account manager if uncertain.

○ I can't see survey results or dashboards. What should I do?

1. Check Response Threshold

- **Minimum 5 Responses Required** - Survey results only display after at least 5 responses collected
- Check your survey's **"User Participation"** section to see response count
- If responses < 5, results will display once threshold is reached
- Wait for more responses to complete, or pause and launch to a different group
- **Example:** If survey shows "3 of 50 participants answered" - results still hidden

2. Verify User Permissions

- Confirm your user role has appropriate access rights
- **Administrators** can see all surveys and all results

- **Managers** can only view their own team's results
- **Employees** have limited access (may not see dashboards depending on permissions)
- If unsure of permissions, contact your administrator
- Request permission updates if you should have dashboard access

3. Check Survey Status

- Confirm survey has completed or is still "Live"
- **Live surveys** show preliminary results (once 5+ responses received)
- **Completed surveys** show final results
- **Paused surveys** show last available results but don't collect new responses
- **Archived/Hidden surveys** may require admin to unhide for viewing
- Check survey list to confirm survey status

4. Verify Correct Survey

- Confirm you're looking at the correct survey (if multiple surveys running)
- Survey name should match what you expected
- Check survey date range to confirm it's the right survey
- If the survey was paused and re-launched, it may appear as a different survey

5. Browser & Cache Issues

- Clear browser cache and cookies:
  - Chrome: Ctrl+Shift+Delete
  - Firefox: Ctrl+Shift+Delete
  - Safari: Preferences > Privacy > Manage Website Data
- Refresh page (Ctrl+R or Cmd+R)
- Try alternative browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge)
- Try incognito/private browsing mode to eliminate extensions
- Check browser console for error messages (F12 or Developer Tools)

6. Data Sync Delay

- If survey just launched, responses may take a few minutes to appear
- Real-time processing occurs but may have 5-minute delay in rare cases
- Refresh page after waiting 5 minutes
- Check if other surveys show data to verify dashboard access works

7. Technical Glitch Assessment

- If you've confirmed:
  - Minimum 5 responses received
  - Correct user permissions
  - Correct survey selected
  - But dashboard still not displaying data
- This may indicate technical system issue

8. Contact Your Account Manager

- Explain the specific issue and steps already taken
- Provide survey name and launch date
- Share response count if known
- Account managers investigate technical issues and provide resolution
- **Expected response:** Within 1 hour for critical issues
- Issue usually resolved within same business day

Our Commitment: Technical issues are rare (less than 0.1% of surveys). If they occur, your dedicated account manager will investigate immediately. We assure you that your data is secure and will be recovered promptly. We have contingency procedures for data recovery and can often restore access within 4 hours.

Contact & Resources

For Questions About Vantage Pulse:

- **Email:** partner@vantagecircle.com
- **Website:** www.vantagecircle.com
- **Account Manager:** Your dedicated point of contact for all inquiries

This FAQ covers the comprehensive functionality of Vantage Pulse. For questions not addressed here, contact your account manager or email partner@vantagecircle.com. We're committed to your success with employee engagement.

Last Updated: *October 2025*
Version: *2.0*
Complete Enterprise FAQ